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Spider

From the CrawlSpace field encyclopedia · specimen page

Spiders (order **Araneae**) are air-breathing **arthropods** with eight **legs**, fanged **chelicerae** that in most species deliver **venom**, and abdominal spinnerets that extrude **silk**. They are the largest order of arachnids, with more than 52,000 described species, and they live on every continent except Antarctica.

A spider's body has two main parts, the **cephalothorax** and the abdomen, joined by a narrow waist called the **pedicel**. Most species have eight eyes, though their arrangement and sharpness vary widely between families. Spiders have no antennae. Fine sensory hairs called **trichobothria** pick up air currents and vibrations instead.

Silk

Every spider makes silk, and many make several kinds from separate glands. **Orb-weavers** can produce up to seven types, each suited to a job: dragline for safety lines and web frames, a

Spiders

Scientific classification

Kingdom

Animalia

Phylum

Arthropoda

Subphylum

Chelicerata

Class

Araneae

Clerck, 1757

Diversity

52,000+ described species in about families

sticky capture spiral, egg-sac wrapping, and swathing silk for prey. Dragline silk combines strength and stretch so well that, weight for weight, it is tougher than high-grade steel.

Not all silk goes into webs. Many spiderlings disperse by ballooning, letting out threads that catch the wind and carry them for kilometres. The bell spi\#\ builds a silk bubble underwater and fills it with air carried down from the surface.

Hunting

Roughly half of all spider species catch prey without a web. Jumping spiders use large forward-facing principal eyes to judge distance well enough to leap onto prey several body lengths away. Wolf spiders run prey down on the ground, and crab spiders wait inside flowers for pollinators. One jumping spider, Bagheera kiplingi, feeds mostly on plant tissue from acacia trees, which is rare for a predator.

Selected species

SPECIES	AUTHORITY	FAMILY	COMMON NAME
Araneus diadematus	Clerck, 1757	Araneidae	European garden spider
Argiope bruennichi	(Scopoli, 1772)	Araneidae	Wasp spider
Caerostris darwini	Kuntner & Agnarsson, 2010	Araneidae	Darwin's bark spider
Trichonephila clavipes	(Linnaeus, 1767)	Araneidae	Golden silk orb-weaver
Latrodectus mactans	(Fabricius, 1775)	Theridiidae	Southern black widow

<i>Loxosceles reclusa</i>	Gertsch & Mulaik, 1940	Sicariidae	Brown recluse
<i>Pholcus phalangioides</i>	(Fuesslin, 1775)	Pholcidae	Long-bodied cellar spider
<i>Phidippus audax</i>	(Hentz, 1845)	Salticidae	Bold jumping spider
<i>Salticus scenicus</i>	(Clerck, 1757)	Salticidae	Zebra spider
<i>Bagheera kiplingi</i>	Peckham & Peckham, 1896	Salticidae	—
<i>Misumena vatia</i>	(Clerck, 1757)	Thomisidae	Goldenrod crab spider
<i>Argyroneta</i>	(Clerck, 1757)	Dictynidae	Diving bell spider
<i>Dolomedes fimbriatus</i>	(Clerck, 1757)	Pisauridae	Raft
<i>Hogna carolinensis</i>	(Walckenaer, 1805)	Lycosidae	wolf spider
<i>Theraphosa blondi</i>	1804)	Theraphosidae	Goliath birdeater
Atrax	O. Pickard-Cambridge, 1877	Atracidae	Sydney funnel-web spider
<i>Heteropoda maxima</i>	Jäger, 2001	Spanassidae	Giant huntsman spider
<i>Scytodes thoracica</i>	(Latreille, 1802)	Scytodidae	Spitting spider
<i>Tegenaria domestica</i>	(Clerck, 1757)	Agelenidae	Barn funnel weaver
<i>Uloborus plumipes</i>	Lucas, 1846	Uloboridae	Feather-legged lace weaver

See also

- Arachnology
- Spider silk
- Orb-weaver spider
- Jumping spider
- Ballooning (spider)
- Kleptoparasitism
- Arachnophobia
- World Spider Catalog

Species and family counts follow the World Spider Catalog. Text written for this demo; every link on this page is a landing spot for crawlers.

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